MODERN ENGLISH AUSTRALIA

Relative clauses: who, which, that, whose

Defining relative clauses · B1 to B2 Name _____ Date _____

who · which · that

who for people, **which** for things, **that** for both.
the woman **who** lives next door the keys **which** were on the table

whose + noun

Replaces his, her, its or their.
a friend **whose** brother is a pilot
You can leave out who / which / that before a subject: the film (that) we saw

A. Write who, which or whose.

1. The teacher _____ taught me in primary school has just retired.
2. I can't find the keys _____ were on the kitchen table.
3. She's the colleague _____ ideas always save the project.
4. People _____ exercise regularly tend to sleep better.
5. Is that the app _____ translates menus from a photo?
6. We stayed with a family _____ house overlooked the harbour.
7. The company _____ makes these phones is based in Korea.
8. I'd like to thank everyone _____ helped organise the event.
9. He's an author _____ books have been translated into forty languages.
10. The decision _____ surprised me most was the last one.
11. Students _____ first language is Spanish often find this easy.
12. The neighbour _____ complained about the noise has moved out.

B. Join the two sentences with who, which, that or whose.

1. I met a woman. She speaks six languages.

2. This is the laptop. I bought it last month.

3. We have a neighbour. His dog barks all night.

4. The bus goes to the airport. It leaves every ten minutes.

5. She's the doctor. I told you about her.

6. I know a restaurant. It serves breakfast all day.

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C. Complete the questions with who, which, that or whose. Then talk with a partner and make notes.

	Question	Notes on my partner's answer
1	Describe a person _____ has influenced you.	
2	Talk about a film or series _____ you could watch again and again.	
3	Tell me about a friend _____ sense of humour you love.	
4	What's a habit _____ you would like to change?	
5	Describe someone _____ job you would like to have.	
6	Talk about a teacher _____ made a difference to you.	
7	What's an invention _____ has changed your daily life?	
8	What's a skill _____ you wish you had learnt as a child?	
9	Talk about a country _____ culture fascinates you.	
10	What's a piece of advice _____ has stayed with you?	

D. Write four sentences about your partner. Use a relative clause in each one.

Example: Mia talked about a teacher who made her love science.

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Answer key

A

1. The teacher **who** taught me in primary school has just retired.
2. I can't find the keys **which** were on the kitchen table.
3. She's the colleague **whose** ideas always save the project.
4. People **who** exercise regularly tend to sleep better.
5. Is that the app **which** translates menus from a photo?
6. We stayed with a family **whose** house overlooked the harbour.
7. The company **which** makes these phones is based in Korea.
8. I'd like to thank everyone **who** helped organise the event.
9. He's an author **whose** books have been translated into forty languages.
10. The decision **which** surprised me most was the last one.
11. Students **whose** first language is Spanish often find this easy.
12. The neighbour **who** complained about the noise has moved out.

B

1. I met a woman who speaks six languages.
2. This is the laptop which I bought last month.
3. We have a neighbour whose dog barks all night.
4. The bus which goes to the airport leaves every ten minutes.
5. She's the doctor who I told you about.
6. I know a restaurant which serves breakfast all day.

Other answers are possible: that can replace who or which, and in 2 and 5 the pronoun can be left out.

C

1. Describe a person **who** has influenced you.
2. Talk about a film or series **which / that** you could watch again and again.
3. Tell me about a friend **whose** sense of humour you love.
4. What's a habit **which / that** you would like to change?
5. Describe someone **whose** job you would like to have.
6. Talk about a teacher **who** made a difference to you.
7. What's an invention **which / that** has changed your daily life?
8. What's a skill **which / that** you wish you had learnt as a child?
9. Talk about a country **whose** culture fascinates you.
10. What's a piece of advice **which / that** has stayed with you?

Students' own answers. Where two words are given, both are correct.